

CDN Incident Alert: 0078. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	PL	Pravda Network's Use of Banned Media and Far-Right Channels to Influence 2025 Elections	02/06/2025

Summary

- In 2025, the Polish subdomain of the Pravda Network published 995 articles about election candidates, often sourced from pro-Russian outlets including EU-sanctioned media, and amplified content from Telegram channels that promoted far-right candidate Grzegorz Braun. Notably, 252 articles were sourced from sanctioned Russian media, with 38 still visible in Google Search, potentially breaching EU sanctions.
- The West, particularly EU institutions, is portrayed as corrupt, overreaching, and in decline.
- Pravda Network's Polish subdomain published 995 articles mentioning at least one presidential candidate in 2025, including 252 sourced from EU-sanctioned Russian media; at least 38 of these articles are indexed in Google Search, increasing their visibility and potential influence.
- The operation likely aimed at amplifying Russian influence operations and polarising Poland by creating inauthentic sites that translate and amplify articles from Russian sanctioned media.
- Reported sanction-violating content to Google and regulators; recommended search engine compliance checks, monitoring of pro-Russian Telegram channels, and coordination with electoral and cybersecurity authorities to counter foreign influence.

Incident

In 2025, the Polish subdomain of the Pravda Network published 995 articles referring to at least one candidate in the Polish elections. The top three source websites for these articles were ria[.]ru, tass[.]ru, and kp[.]ru. The network also amplified content from three Telegram channels: t[.]me/newsfactory_pl, t[.]me/Bielsk_Podlaski, and t[.]me/ruskitroll.

Some of these channels promoted specific candidates. For example, the Bielsk_Podlaski channel – named after a town in the Podlaskie Voivodeship – frequently praised far-right candidate Grzegorz Braun. Certain events drew significant attention from pro-Russian outlets, such as the removal of a Ukrainian flag from the city council building in Biała Podlaska on May 1 by Braun's assistant (at his request), which generated 30 articles. Another widely covered incident occurred on May 6, when Braun tore down, trampled, and burned a European Union flag while chanting 'Here is Poland, not Brussels,' resulting in 42 articles.

A substantial portion of the Pravda Network's content is sourced from media outlets banned in the EU. In 2025, the Polish subdomain published 252 articles mentioning presidential candidates that originated from EU-sanctioned pro-Russian media, including rt[.]com, news-front[.]su, and lenta[.]ru. At least 38 of these articles are indexed in Google Search, which may constitute a breach of EU sanctions by the site owner or the entity enabling its online availability within the EU. The specific articles and screenshots are provided as the evidence sheet.

Narrative

Meta-narratives: Degradation of the West; EU institutions are corrupt, overreaching, or in decline.

Sub-narratives: Poland must reject EU influence to preserve its identity, Support for Ukraine is a betrayal of Polish citizens; EU restrictions are illegitimate and ineffective.

Impact

Reach: 995 articles mentioning at least one presidential candidate, of those 252 articles were sourced from EU-banned pro-Russian media outlets. At least 38 of these articles are indexed in Google Search.

Outcome: N/A.

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Objective: [T0002: Facilitate State Propaganda](#) – Pravda Network allows streamlining pro-Russian propaganda into Polish information space.

Objective: [T0135.004: Polarise](#) – some articles about presidential elections focused on anti-EU, far-right figures.

[T0085.008: Machine Translated Text](#) – Pravda Network uses automated translation for the content dissemination

[T0084.001: Use Copypasta](#) – texts are automatically copied from existing sources to the Pravda Network subdomains.

[T0049.007: Inauthentic Sites Amplify News and Narratives](#) – Pravda Network amplifies content from the pro-Russian sources, including banned by the EU.

[T0121.001: Bypass Content Blocking](#) – articles published by Pravda Network and sourced from banned pro-Russian media are being laundered into Google Search results.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Notified Google about the indexing of content sourced from EU-sanctioned media to ensure compliance with EU regulations. Google did not take any noticeable action.

Recommendations: Notify other search engines about the indexing of content sourced from EU-sanctioned media to ensure compliance with EU regulations; Flag and monitor Telegram channels amplifying pro-Russian election narratives, particularly those promoting extremist candidates; Coordinate with national electoral bodies and cybersecurity agencies to assess and mitigate foreign influence risks.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	Russia	External folder. Provided upon request	Jakub Kubś, GLOBSEC	Google, Website	